

# Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

## Altec Lansing 641 4.1 Speakers

Too powerful for your own good

The subwoofer for the Altec Lansing 641 4.1 is massive. It's the biggest the Test Centre has seen, and chances are it could give you a hernia if you don't lift it carefully.

Although the 641 is only 200 W RMS, compared to 550 for the Creative Megaworks, its satellites and woofer



are double the size and weight. Though this doesn't mean much in terms of performance, you'll definitely need plenty of room to be able to use these speakers.

One of our favourite bass tests is playing the opening cinematic of *Quake III Arena*—especially the part where the cigar butt falls to the ground. The 641 beat even the Megaworks 550 subwoofer. As far as bass goes, there's nothing better—yet.

The satellites are nice and heavy and sit firmly on your desktop. We recommend you place the subwoofer on the carpet, in the biggest room you have available. You'll know why as soon as you begin to crank up the volume knob.

Yes, the knob. Nice piece of work this. The designers at Altec have come up with a really nifty design to control volume levels, using just a knob and two buttons for the bass and treble. Pressing either of these buttons makes the knob control that effect. After a few seconds, control passes automatically back to the volume level. Also, a series of LEDs

light up to show you how high you've gone.

Make sure to nail down loose furniture and board up the windows before you turn that volume up. We only recommend this system to those who live in mansions, or those who like to show off.

### SPECIFICATIONS

200W RMS, frequency response 27 Hz~20 KHz, signal to noise ratio at 1 KHz >70 dB, crossover frequency 100 Hz, system Total Harmonic Distortion < 0.3% at 10 dB, input impedance 10 KOhms, satellite drivers 1-inch tweeter and 3-inch mid-range, subwoofer drivers 2 6.5-inch Long Throw woofers.

#### Altec Lansing 641 4.1 Speaker System **A-**

|                 |        |
|-----------------|--------|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Build quality   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |

**Price:** Rs 20,000  
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## Sony SDM-N80 18.1" LCD Monitor

Redefined silhouette

Viewing LCDs will never be the same again, once you set your eyes on the 18-inch SDM-N80 LCD monitor from Sony. The package consists of the LCD monitor and an external device that supplies power to the monitor. Called the Media Engine, this device has points that connect to the display card as well as to another digital display device. In-built speakers on the side of the device add to the multimedia experience, but they're quite tinny.

The LCD has a stylish-looking control panel on the top of the screen. Support for USB is also provided, with a mini 2-port hub at the back. The recommended resolution for the display is 1280 x 1024 at 60 Hz. The maximum angle tilt is 60 degrees, but there's hardly any height adjustment possible.

In the test we conducted using the Display Mate Video Edition software, the horizontal, vertical and diagonal lines were very sharp, but

with a tinge of yellow. There was hardly any sign of streaking or ghosting, but there were dark corners when we inspected the purity of the

RGB colours. With hardly any flicker, almost perfect screen uniformity, and an absolute zero mirror reflection in the dark screen test, this LCD performs very well indeed.

One cause for concern is the fact that the LCD is completely useless without the external box. And considering the size of the screen, the price tag is a little on the expensive side. Style-wise though, the product scores full marks, and will definitely add a lot of appeal to any desk.

### SPECIFICATIONS

18.1-inch a-Si (Amorphous-Silicon) TFT active matrix panel, 1,600 x 1,200 maximum resolution, 2 USB ports, external power supply with connections for alternate display source, sound connectors, Mac-compatible display connection

#### Sony SDM-N80 18.1" LCD Monitor **B+**

|                 |        |
|-----------------|--------|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Build Quality   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |

**Price:** Rs. 1,49,000  
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